



Document Management System



Sultanate of Oman

Ministry of Health

The Royal Hospital

Department of Emergency and Disaster Preparedness

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Title: Contingency Plan for Electronic Health Records (Al-Shifa System)

Royal hospital Contingency Plan for Electronic Health Records (Al-Shifa System)

I. Purpose

This Contingency Plan is to establish procedures to ensure that the Royal Hospital will continue to provide quality care in the event of a disruption in services provided by the Information Technology (IT) department.

The plan will provide a process to reduce the effects of adverse events and provide alternate methods for delivering critical interim support for electronic health records (EHR), notify staff when such an event occurs, and provide for an expedient recovery process.

II. Policy

1. All wards/clinics must have EHR downtime contingency plan for 72 hours. This includes having a file with all needed forms and nursing and doctor notes papers to sustain the service without EHR. This must be insured by the nurse in charge and the file should be updated every three months.
2. All Royal Hospital staff using the EHR System must be notified when any type of disruption is occurring or is planned. Disruption of the EHR can have critical effect on patient care. The type of disruption and the anticipated time of recovery should be communicated so Department Directors can plan on necessary actions to take during the disruption. The IT Staff is responsible for notifying administration and concerned areas when serious/major disruptions are occurring.
3. A planned system shutdown to repair/maintain the system should be done only when the outpatient clinics are closed. For planned system shutdowns, staff should be given at least 24 hours notice so that appropriate planning may be accomplished in the clinic/wards. If a system shutdown cannot wait until when the clinics is closed, IT staff should attempt to wait until as much time as possible, to allow for proper planning.
4. For all unplanned system disruptions, staff should be notified as quickly as possible so that the proper level of the EHR Contingency plan may be initiated. This notification is very important for efficient, quality patient care to continue at the health centers involved.
5. All possible efforts must be made so that downtime is kept to a minimum.

III. Procedure

1. If users encounter problems with the computer systems, please notify IT: Al-shifa Support team 9751

If deemed a hardware problem and it is not correctable within 15 minutes, a replacement PC/equipment will be installed.

All incidents of disruption or significant slowing should be reported to the IT staff. A working order log is located on the server and entries will be made for all reported problems.

For down-times extending greater than 15 minutes, it is expected that clinic/ward will implement the contingency plan.

If no response call 5339

If the problem involved Equipment malfunction call 5132

IT will then perform simple troubleshooting to determine if this is a hardware problem, software problem, connectivity issue, etc. At that time an assessment of the degree of disruption will be estimated.

2. Limited hardware or network disruptions: If it does not involve a complete shutdown of the system and maybe hardware related. The IT Staff will make every attempt to eliminate the problem for the user.

If deemed a hardware problem and it is not correctable within 15 minutes, a replacement PC/equipment will be installed.

All incidents of disruption or significant slowing should be reported to the IT staff. A working order log is located on the server and entries will be made for all reported problems.

For down-times extending greater than 15 minutes, it is expected that clinic/ward will implement the contingency plan.

3. Serious or major disruption in services will involve some amount of system downtime. The IT Staff will notify administration and all departments concerned. They will announce through operator the system will be shutdown or is already down, the time of the shutdown, and the estimated downtime. This announcement must occur 3 times so that all persons in various areas of the hospital have a chance to hear. In the afterhours the nursing duty director should be notified. In addition, IT will utilize the Alshifa Broadcast Feature to notify all users when there are advanced warning for a complete system shutdown.

The IT staff will keep staff informed of progress/anticipated length of downtime.

B. Clinic/ Wards Operational Procedure

1. Health Summaries

- a. With an advanced notice of an impending system shut down, every attempt should be made to generate a Health Summary for all patients. This includes but not limited to, admission notes, current status, summary of investigations, management plan. For clinics previous visit details should be printed

1. Patient Registration

The patient will check-in at the registration desk by the medical record staff.

The staff generates a File ID Slip, which contains the name, DOB, chart number; check-in time, and which clinic the patient has appointment in.

2. Doctors and Nurses Documentation

b. Post Recovery Data-Entry:

- Patient updates will be entered by medical records staff. Doctors and nurses noted will be entered by them.

3. Laboratory

- a. Lab orders must be placed on the appropriate lab requisition form.
- b. Results: Results will be picked-up by the respective OPD/ward medical orderly on a regular basis.
- c. Critical values will be phoned by the lab technician
- d. Post-Recovery Data Entry: Orders & results will be entered into the Alshifa by Lab Staff

4. Radiology

- a. Diagnostic imaging orders will be placed on the Diagnostic Imaging Request form.
- b. Results: Radiology department will generate hard copied exams for physician viewing in clinic/wards
- c. Radiology report will be released in the same request form.
- d. Post-Recovery Data Entry: Radiology department will ensure all exams available in Al-Shifa system. All Orders and reports will be entered into the system by radiology staff.

5. Pharmacy:

Paper prescription will be used for outpatient prescription. A note of all prescribed medication will be entered in the charts.

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